Bathrooms — showers, gradients, waterproofing and accessibility

Does new grout eliminate shower leaks?

Only if the defect is limited to the joint. Leakage through junctions, seals, the drain or waterproofing membrane requires locating and correcting the actual point. Regrouting and painting do not replace defective waterproofing.

When must a shower tray be lifted?

When inspection shows external repair cannot resolve leaks in connections, the trap, support or waterproofing. The decision depends on access and diagnosis, rather than merely a stain.

What should be checked when installing a level-access shower?

Available levels, drain gradient, run length, watertightness, waterproofing junction and access level. Without measurements, do not assure that it can be completely flush.

Can a small bathroom be made accessible?

It may be possible, but doors, clearances, manoeuvring space, shower, sanitary fittings and level changes must be measured against the requirements applicable to the work. A step-free shower alone does not make the entire bathroom accessible.

Must the extractor switch on with the light?

Various controls and timers are available; what matters is ensuring ventilation appropriate to use and applicable regulations. Do not confuse switching on with meeting airflow requirements.

What should I do about mould near the bathroom window?

Check condensation and ventilation, possible water ingress through the envelope and thermal bridges. Cleaning and drying without resolving recurring moisture is usually insufficient.

Can the toilet be moved without opening the floor?

It depends on stack positions, route, gradient and available height. Relocation may require building work or an accessible solution. Do not promise feasibility from a photograph alone.

What should be checked if the basin drains slowly?

Check blockages, the trap and drainage ventilation/gradient using professional judgement. Avoid dangerous chemical mixtures and do not dismantle communal pipework without authorisation.

What finish is suitable for a shower floor?

Prioritise compatibility with the waterproofing system, maintenance and appropriate slip resistance. Aesthetic choice does not replace safety requirements for use.

How is a renovated shower handed over?

Verify drainage, connections, seals, finishing details, cleaning, maintenance information and agreed operating tests. Document concealed work before closing up.

Case B-11 — Leakage to the neighbour below

Hypothetical assessment case, not completed work or a service committed to by Riansares 4R.

Situation: Damp appears beneath a newly renovated shower.

Checks: Inspect seals, drainage and tray junctions before deciding on demolition.

Possible scope: Repair according to cause and watertightness testing.

Decision criterion: Do not automatically attribute leakage to the visible joint.

Evidence to retain: Photos, discharge test and traceability.

Case B-12 — Windowless bathroom

Hypothetical assessment case, not completed work or a service committed to by Riansares 4R.

Situation: An owner wants to eliminate persistent mould and odours.

Checks: Ventilation, condensation, leaks and substrate moisture.

Possible scope: Ventilation solution, water repair and compatible finishes.

Decision criterion: Do not promise results from anti-mould paint alone.

Evidence to retain: Measurements, explanation and maintenance.

Industry references and scope

- CTE_HS.
- CTE_SUA.
- EPA.

The references provide general context and do not establish that Riansares 4R has carried out work. Technical requirements must be verified for the applicable type of intervention and jurisdiction.